

U1L04 Quick Reference — HTML Links

Syntax

Goal	Code
External site	<code>Text</code>
Open in new tab	<code>Text</code>
Your own page	<code>Text</code>
Section of this page	<code>Text</code>
Name a section	<code><h2 id="name">Heading</h2></code>
Email	<code>Text</code>
Email + subject	<code>Text</code>
Phone	<code>Text</code>

Anatomy

```
<a href="https://www.khanacademy.org">Practice math for free</a>
```

- `<a>` ... `</a>` — the **anchor** tag
- `href` — **hypertext reference**, the destination
- Text between — what the user sees and clicks

💡 **Attribute** = extra info inside a tag, written `name="value"`. Attributes go in the **opening** tag only.

Absolute vs Relative

Type	Example	Use for
Absolute	<code>https://www.nasa.gov</code>	Other people's sites
Relative	<code>about.html</code>	Your own pages

Absolute is a full mailing address — works from anywhere.

Relative is "two doors down" — only makes sense from where you are.

⚠️ `href="www.google.com"` with no `https://` makes the browser look for a **file on your computer**.

`target="_blank"`

```
<a href="https://www.nasa.gov" target="_blank">
  Explore NASA missions (opens in a new tab)
</a>
```

Use it	Don't use it
Links leaving your site	Links to your own pages

💡 Add "(opens in a new tab)" to the text. A sighted user *sees* the new tab; a screen reader user doesn't.

⚠️ Underscore required: `_blank`, not `blank`.

Link Text

Test: read only the link text, with no sentence around it. Do you know where it goes?

❌ Bad	✅ Good
<code>Click here</code>	<code>Practice math on Khan Academy</code>

✗ Bad	✓ Good
Read more	Read the field trip permission form
https://www.khanacademy.org	Khan Academy's free courses

💡 **Why:** screen readers can list every link on a page. Out of context, "click here, click here, click here" is useless.

Internal Navigation

Step 1 — name the destination:

```
<h2 id="contact">Contact Information</h2>
```

Step 2 — link to that name:

```
<a href="#contact">Jump to contact info</a>
```

Rules for id

Rule	Example
Unique on the page	Only one <code>id="contact"</code>
No spaces	<code>my-hobbies</code> , not <code>my hobbies</code>
# in the href only	<code>id="contact"</code> + <code>href="#contact"</code>

Back to top

```
<h1 id="top">My Website</h1>
...
<a href="#top">Back to top</a>
```

Email & Phone

```
<a href="mailto:emrgem@bergen.org">Email Mr. Gemic</a>
<a href="mailto:emrgem@bergen.org?subject=Question">Ask a question</a>
<a href="tel:+12015551234">Call (201) 555-1234</a>
```

⚠ No `https://` and no `//` on these — just `mailto:` or `tel:` then the value.

⚠ `tel:` takes **digits only**. `555-TRIP-123` will not dial.

💡 `mailto:` needs an email app installed and `tel:` does nothing on most desktops — so print the address and number as visible text too.

Fixes

Problem	Cause	Fix
"File not found" on a real site	Missing <code>https://</code>	Add the protocol
Anchor link does nothing	Missing <code>#</code> in href	<code>href="#name"</code>
Anchor jumps to the wrong spot	Duplicate <code>id</code>	Make every id unique
Link opens in the same tab	No <code>target</code>	Add <code>target="_blank"</code>
Whole page is one giant link	Missing <code></code>	Close the anchor
Email link does nothing	No email app set up	Expected — show the address as text

Complete Working Page

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <title>My Resources</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1 id="top">My Favorite Resources</h1>

  <p><a href="#learning">Learning Sites</a></p>

  <h2 id="learning">Learning Sites</h2>
  <p>I practice on
  <a href="https://www.khanacademy.org" target="_blank">Khan
  Academy (opens in a new tab)</a>.</p>

  <hr>

  <p><a href="mailto:emrgem@bergen.org">Email Mr. Gemici</a></p>
  <p><a href="#top">Back to top</a></p>
</body>
</html>
```